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Culture (OWC): [Turkana \(FL17\)](#)

Region: Africa

Sub Region: Eastern Africa

Field Date: 1980-1996

Coverage Date: 1961-2004

Place Coverage: Turkana, Kenya

Section Title(S): ANGOROT

ANGOROT

Angorot is perhaps the most intelligent and articulate man I met during my entire time working with the Turkana. When I first met him he was in his early forties and living with three wives (one of them inherited), four brothers, and his mother. His herds consisted of 107 cattle, 68 camels, 722 goats, and 269 sheep. Although this number of livestock is considered a large holding, Angorot was not deemed to be a rich man. Angorot's fifth brother, Aki, was in prison when I first started working with him. The Kenya government disarmed the Ngisonyoka in 1979, and Aki was caught with a rifle. He was released in 1982 and returned to the awi, where he remained throughout the study period. Akopenyon was the principal manager of the camel herd and would accompany the nonmilking camels when they were separated from the awi. Nakwawi and later Lokora took care of the goats and sheep, and Erionga took care of the cattle. Before being sent to prison, Aki was in charge of the cattle, and after his return he took care of cattle when they were at the awi, but Erionga managed them when they were separated. Two features seem to characterize all of Angorot's brothers: a strong sense of responsibility and their playful sense of humor. Aki, for instance, loved to conceal my tape recorder and record parts of a conversation when people were visiting, then play the tape back catching them off guard. He would laugh so hard that sometimes he would fall off his *ekicholon* (small stool). His other brothers were not the jokesters that Aki was, but they all loved to play small jokes on each other and sometimes visitors (myself included).

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In 1980 Angorot's awi consisted of six ekols. The first ekol belonged to Angorot's mother, Nakadeli. Angorot's unmarried brothers, Akopenyon, Nakwawi, Erionga, and Lorkora, also slept there when they were at the awi, as did Angorot's unmarried sister Kochodin. Nakadeli was the matriarch of the awi and offered advice and helped wherever needed. It was important that each of Angorot's wives get along with her as she clearly could influence Angorot in decisions related to the household. As is Turkana custom, each of

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the wives 111 spent their initial years in the ekol of the household head's mother, living with and assisting her until the new wife had given birth.

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